

Take the example of life insurance. There are innumerable products available in the market today that can confuse you on where to invest and how much to invest so that you are financially secure as well as get returns on your investments.

If you keep things simple, the first fundamental question is: Why do you need to insure yourself? The answer is: So that your loved ones and dependents can enjoy the same quality of life even after you are not around. Therefore, for life insurance, you need a product that provides exactly this – term insurance. Why mix insurance with investment? Why complicate things when you can keep them simple?

As long as you keep things simple and trust your own judgment based on your own knowledge, you will always be better off in the long run.

Trust me, you need freedom

Once, when I was on my weekly shopping expedition, with my family, at an Indian grocery, I met one of my colleagues in the store. Not that there was anything special about meeting a colleague, but that day he seemed very disturbed about something. On enquiry I learnt that his father had been detected with last stage cancer. Not only was it an emotional shock for him, but he was also concerned about its financial implications. His father would have to undergo a series of chemotherapy treatments for at least a year, before his prognosis would be realistically known.

I still remember the moment when I put my hand on his shoulder, looked into his eyes and told him that if he needed any kind of financial help, I would be ever willing. The moment I uttered these words, I felt very satisfied. I am telling you this because like most of you, I have faced similar situations in my life but I never had the means to openly offer any kind of financial help to anyone, even though I wanted to. I was always worried about my own future and that of my immediate family.

For me, this was a massive shift in the way I used to think and in the very purpose of my existence. I was moving from asking for help or being self sufficient at best, to being "able to help others". If you have never experienced such a feeling, you will not realize how satisfied you feel when